

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #137

Rhythm, Time and Groove (or Feel) are three words that get thrown around a lot, much of the time as if they are the same thing, or interchangeable. They are actually very distinct things, and they talk about three very differently aspects of music. The confusion is likely because they all have to do with "where things happen in time." A quick and easy way to think about these items might be something like this -

## Time = Where Is It?

## Groove = Is It Awesome?

Rhythm is literally talking about the exact written rhythms of a piece of music. "Is it on beat two, or on the + of 3?" Time is referring to the evenness of the rhythms we are playing. "Are the correct rhythms we are playing dragging or rushing? Are the beats we are playing even with each other?" And then Groove. That's the gravy we pour on it all. Groove is what happens between the beats. Groove is that special sauce that seeps into the nooks and crannies between the pulses. Rhythm is a solid, and Groove is a liquid.

## #1 - Rhythm

"Rhythm" is simply about playing correct rhythms of a piece of music. Could we recognize and write down what you just played?



## #2 - Time

"Time" changes nothing in the notation. It has to do with our ability to play the rhythms, relative to a steady beat.



### #3 - Groove

Again, "Groove" changes nothing in the notation. It has to do with HOW we subdivide the 8ths and 16ths, the little extras we put in there.



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